

Livestream Platform Case Study

Growth and 0-to-1 Products on a Top Live-Streaming Platform (Huajiao)

One-line judgement: On a live-streaming platform, growth isn't a marketing problem — it's a product one: get the right viewer into the right room fast, and give creators tools worth coming back to.

Role & Scope

Role: Senior Product Manager, Huajiao (2018–2021)

Product: User growth and the creator content ecosystem on a top Chinese live-streaming platform — plus new 0-to-1 live formats.

Scope: Onboarding and discovery, content distribution, creator/operation tooling, digital-human and voice live products, cross-functional delivery.

Context

A live-streaming platform lives or dies on two loops: viewers finding a room worth staying in, and creators finding it worth going live. When discovery is weak, good creators go unseen and viewers bounce — supply and demand starve each other.

Problem

The problem wasn't *"we need more traffic."* It was:

"Viewers arrive but don't land in a room they'll stay in, and creators don't have the tools to keep them — so both sides leak."

Growth had to be fixed at the product layer — discovery, onboarding and creator tooling — not bought with marketing.

Insight

Live-streaming growth compounds when you shorten the path from **open the app** to **a room worth watching**, and give creators reasons to keep going live. The lever is product, not spend.

Strategic Decisions

1. **Rebuilt discovery as the growth engine — product, not spend.** Redesigned Channels, Nearby and Moments with AI-based content distribution so the right viewer reached the right room in fewer steps, and treated retained creators, not just viewers, as the compounding growth lever.
2. **Built creator tooling worth returning to.** Shipped creator and operation capability tools used across **13K+ daily livestreams**, raising creator operational efficiency and lifting content quality — because retained creators are what retain viewers.
3. **Shipped new 0-to-1 formats.** Delivered the company's **first digital-human livestreaming product** and an **audio live product** from 0-to-1, plus interactive variety formats — coordinating 30+ cross-functional stakeholders under tight timelines.

Outcomes & Impact

- Discovery redesign lifted **CTR +27%** and **retention +10.3%**.
- Raised **onboarding conversion +7% (iOS) / +11% (Android)** through funnel analysis and platform-specific growth experiments.
- Creator/operation tooling used across **13K+ daily livestreams**, improving creator operational efficiency ~17%.

- Delivered **first digital-human livestreaming** and an **audio live product** — 0-to-1 formats that expanded how people could go live.

What I Learned

- **On social/live products, growth is discovery.** The highest-leverage growth work was shortening the path to a room worth watching — a product problem, not a marketing one.
- **Retain the creators and you retain the audience.** Tooling that made creators more effective did more for growth than any single viewer-side feature.
- **Ship new formats to learn the platform's edges.** Building digital-human and voice live 0-to-1 surfaced where the product — and the market — could actually go next.